

don't even want to list them. A few of the popular Web conferencing apps are proprietary and some of them were even in the news for their alleged security breaches. So, as always, we can depend on free and open-source alternatives.

In this article, we discuss a Moodle plugin to conduct Web conferencing — the BigBlueButtonBN. This plugin maintained by Fred Dixon and Jesus Federico, allows us to integrate the application BigBlueButton into Moodle. BigBlueButton is a free and open source Web conferencing application. Notice the difference between the BigBlueButtonBN and the BigBlueButton, as the former is a plugin that allows the use of the latter in Moodle. A similar difference applies to Interactive Content – H5P plugin and H5P as discussed in the previous article.

Let us begin by installing the BigBlueButtonBN plugin in Moodle. The zipped installation file of the BigBlueButtonBN plugin called *mod_bigbluebuttonbn_moodle39_2019042009.zip* is available for download at https://moodle.org/plugins/mod_bigbluebuttonbn.

As usual, we will try the installation steps first in the local copy of Moodle installed in our system, so as to avoid any potential harm to your up and running Moodle server. Log in as *admin user* and then go to *Dashboard > Site administration > Plugins > Install plugins* in Moodle. Now, drag and drop the zipped installation file of the BigBlueButtonBN plugin downloaded earlier. Click on the button *Install plugin* from the ZIP file, and you will be taken to the installation window of the BigBlueButtonBN plugin.

In the installation window, click on the button 'continue' whenever prompted; then press the button 'Upgrade Moodle database now' and save the changes. The BigBlueButtonBN plugin will be successfully installed in your Moodle.

In the previous article in this series, we had created a course called H5P101 and three users — an admin user, a user called *Guru* (a teacher) and a user called *Shishya* (a student) in the local copy of our Moodle. This time we will create a new course called BBB101 and add the user *Guru* as a teacher to this course and the user *Shishya* as a student to the course. As mentioned earlier, all this can be done by following the simple steps provided in the previous article.

Now let us try to set up a Web conference between our teacher and student of the course BBB101 using the BigBlueButtonBN plugin. Login as the user *Guru*, so that Web conferencing can be done as an activity in the course BBB101. Notice that a user with the privilege *Student* cannot add or edit any activity in a course in Moodle.

You can get the course page by going to *Dashboard > Courses > BBB101* in Moodle. On this course page, click the button 'Turn editing on'. On the right side of the general beginning block and all the blocks corresponding to each week of the course (since we have chosen a weekly format for the course BBB101), you can see a link named

'Add an activity or resource', which allows us to add activities and resources to this Moodle course.

Let us enable video conferencing between the participants of this course by using the BigBlueButtonBN plugin. To set up the Web conferencing in the general block at the beginning itself, click on the link named 'Add an activity or resource' and we will get the selection window shown in Figure 1, listing a lot of Moodle activities and resources. The plugin for the activity of our current interest, the BigBlueButtonBN, is marked with a bold green circle in Figure 1.

Click on the button shown in Figure 1 and you will be taken to a window to set up the Web conference by providing some essential details. Figure 2 shows a part of this window to set up a Web conference.

You need to provide some essential details like *instance type* (you can decide whether you need activities and/or recording), *virtual classroom name* (we chose *Class OSFY*), *participants* (you can add participants and assign roles to them), and a schedule for the session (opening and closing time). Of course, there are a lot of other options as well, so that you can control the Web

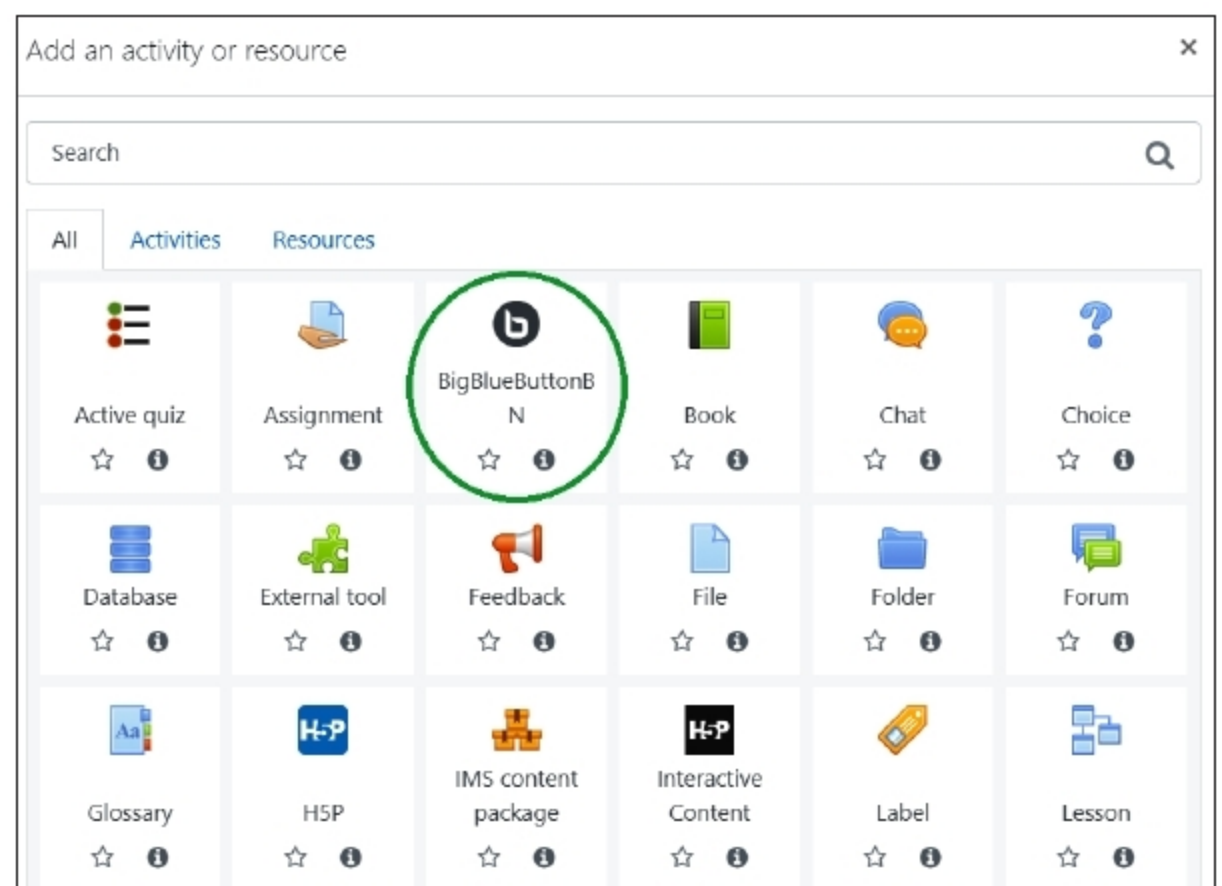


Figure 1: Moodle activities and resources